Chapter 1: The most important idea of my life

Why does the most powerful technology of our time bear the seal of a Caribbean paradise and how was the idea of creating the .ia Denomination of Origin born?

First and most important: welcome. I hope you find this story enjoyable and fun.

Where do I start? To introduce myself: my name is Eloy López, I am 47 years old, I have lived in Alcorcón for twenty years, but I come from Tarragona. I work as a computer scientist and programmer, and I am a disastrous father. I have the pathetic ability of not being good at almost anything. Well, I lie: there is something I am good at, thinking. I can spend hours thinking about my moves. Since I was little I have always had the feeling that I thought more than the rest. This doesn't mean I'm smarter; On the contrary, I have always thought that in terms of intelligence I was one step behind average, but, thanks to that extra ability to think things through, I was capable of solving any problem that crossed my path.

And that's what this story is about: an idea that occurred to me that has the potential to change the future of civilization as we know it. And I'm not exaggerating.

What is that idea? The year was 2019 and I was surfing on the internet. At that time, artificial intelligence was already hitting hard and some companies were beginning to adopt the .ai domain, which caught my attention. I thought: if there is an English version, surely in Spanish I can register a domain with great potential. But no: the domain .ia does not exist. A pity. To register a ccTLD there was only one way (at least that I knew of at the time): it had to be associated with an independent geographical territory. For example, Isle of Man corresponds to .im. Because of that rule of three, I started looking for islands. At first I looked for Spanish islands that began with "A", but at one point Antikythera occurred to me and something "clicked" in my head. It was an absolute crush: the more I analyzed it, the more perfect the idea became. The ingenuity of our ancestors, the first analog computer in history, was the perfect symbol for modern artificial intelligence. But well, this was still a nice chimera in my head. Impossible, you say? "Hold my cubata"... and thus began the Odyssey of the .ia.